leveraging the instruments of the State. Maharashtra, and by extension the entire nation, is grappling with a systematic attempt to undermine the Constitution and the values enshrined within it. We both agreed that this situation needed our collective attention and action, and taking to the streets was the first step.

The Yatra thus symbolizes our collective effort to stand against the BJP's assault on democracy. The MVA joined it in the pursuit of a common cause —namely the protection of our people, our democracy and our Constitution. We all felt that remaining silent in these unprecedented times was simply not an option, and that we must align ourselves with the truth and the people.

I was encouraged to see that the vast multitudes of Maharashtra also joined hands in this quest. Ordinary Maharashtrians came from faraway villages and talukas across the state. Old women, young children, dynamic youngsters and working professionals across the state raucously embraced and joined us. They not only expressed solidarity with us, but also expressed their steadfast determination to work with us. They enthusiastically sought to participate in what many of them called India's second freedom struggle. This overwhelming encouragement from the people conferred a heavy responsibility on all of us. It is because of this that we all decided that the MVA alliance's core principles must be replicated at the national level. It is that shared concern and commitment that became the bedrock of the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA).

INDIA is firmly committed to upholding liberty, equality, fraternity and justice, as well as our federal structure. Every meeting we have had, in Patna, Bengaluru, Mumbai and Delhi, was constructively dedicated to furthering the well-being of the Indian people. INDIA is also resolutely against everything the BJP stands for—which is obsessed with the imposition of one leader, one ideology and one party. They have divided India with hate and violence, simply to plunder our nation's vast resources and remain in power for a few years more. The Yatra, the MVA and INDIA are thus different instruments to counter the BJP's insidious agenda and